Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

THIRD REGULAR SESSION

PARLIAMENT RESOLUTION NO. 491

RESOLUTION ISSUING DRESS CODE GUIDELINES FOR PARLIAMENTARY STAFF AND VISITORS DURING PARLIAMENT SESSIONS

WHEREAS, Sections 2 and 3, Article XVI of Republic Act No. 11054, otherwise known as *"Organic Law for the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao"*, provide that the Bangsamoro Transition Authority (BTA) is the interim government in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region during the transition period, and it shall exercise legislative and executive powers in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region during the transition period;

WHEREAS, Section 25, Article VII of the aforementioned law provides that Parliament shall adopt its own rules for the conduct of its business;

WHEREAS, Bangsamoro Transition Authority (BTA) Resolution No. 268, or the *"Resolution Providing for Rules, Procedures and Practices of the Bangsamoro Transition Authority Parliament"*, otherwise known as *"the Rules"*, guides the conduct of all sessions, committee hearings, meetings, and other similar activities of the BTA;

WHEREAS, Section 2, Rule XXVIII of the Rules on *"Discipline of Non-Members"* provides that the *"Parliament and its committees shall have the right to be protected from annoyance by non-Members, and its full authority can be exercised by the Speaker. The Speaker shall direct the non-members to leave the plenary or order the Sergeant-at-Arms to remove them at any time during the session. If a person refuses to leave the plenary, the Speaker shall take necessary measures to ensure that the order is enforced;"*

WHEREAS, Section 4(h) of RA 6713 or the *"Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees"* provides that *"public officials and employees and their families shall lead modest lives appropriate to their positions and income. They shall not indulge in extravagant or ostentatious display of wealth in any form;"*

WHEREAS, in keeping with the dignity of the Bangsamoro Parliament, Parliamentary staff and visitors present in the Parliament building during sessions are enjoined to observe the proper dress code;

WHEREAS, there is a necessity to establish clear dress code guidelines that best reflect the Parliament's dignity and are also in keeping with applicable laws;

WHEREAS, the dress code guidelines shall provide for the type of attire that parliamentary staff and visitors are prescribed to wear, the types of attire that are considered inappropriate, as well as the corresponding sanctions in case of violations thereof:

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved, by the Bangsamoro Parliament, To issue Dress Code Guidelines for Parliamentary staff and visitors during plenary sessions.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, To adopt the following Dress Code Guidelines for Parliamentary staff and visitors during Parliament sessions.

DRESS CODE GUIDELINES FOR PARLIAMENTARY STAFF AND VISITORS DURING PARLIAMENT SESSIONS

In keeping with the dignity, honor, virtue, and integrity of the Parliament, Parliamentary staff and visitors shall adhere to the following dress code guidelines during parliamentary sessions:

SECTION 1. During sessions, Parliamentary staff and visitors shall wear formal, business, smart casual or modest cultural attire.

SECTION 2. The secretariat, legislative pages, security personnel, and other similar parliamentary staff in the session premises shall wear their appropriate uniforms and visible Anti-Red Tape Authority (ARTA) identification cards.

SECTION 3. Subject to exceptional cases, staff of the respective Members of Parliament and visitors, including caterers, shall be issued temporary visible ARTA ID cards for identification purposes.

SECTION 4. The following are considered inappropriate for the abovementioned personnel and visitors to wear during parliament sessions:

(a) Tattered or distressed denim jeans;

(b) Slippers;

(c) Noisy or distracting footwear;

(d) Miniskirts or shorts above knee length;

(e) Outfits with plunging necklines;

(f) Clothing in neon colors;

(g) Caps or hats, except for religious or cultural headwear;

(h) Sleeveless garments;

(i) Leggings; and

(j) Any clothing with offensive or inappropriate text or images.

SECTION 5. Non-compliance with these guidelines shall result in denial of entry to the session hall. This includes adherence to the provisions under the Seasonal Dress Code and Medical Exemptions.

Seasonal Dress Code and Medical Exemptions:

(a) The Office of the Secretary-General may implement a seasonal dress code during the hottest months, allowing for more heat-appropriate yet professional attire.

(b) Staff members with medical conditions exacerbated by heat may apply for a medical exemption to certain dress code rules by presenting a valid medical certificate to the Office of the Secretary-General.

(c) The Parliament shall consult with health professionals to develop guidelines for heat-appropriate professional wear that do not compromise on formality or respect for the institution.

SECTION 6. The Office of the Secretary-General, the Protocol and Decorum Division, and the Sergeant-at-Arms are directed to ensure faithful compliance with these guidelines.

RESOLVED, FINALLY, that this Resolution shall take effect immediately upon its approval and shall remain in force perpetually unless a new set of guidelines on the same subject matter is issued.

ADOPTED, *Safar* 17, 1446/August 21, 2024.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

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